

Experience Concept Analysis

Experience Concept

Find Your Batik is a mobile experience where customers can explore different looks offered by Heritage Bay, and visualise how the clothing pieces will look on them. The customer can first get styling inspiration from the brand's product photoshoots, or inspiration from other customers. The highlight of the experience is the AI Fitting Room, where customers can upload a full body picture of themselves, and receive a generated image of them "wearing" the clothing piece they are interested in. It introduces a digitalised version of a fitting room experience, which would have only been possible in physical retail stores.

Each stage of my UX Flow has its own similarities to a physical retail experience:

1. Select style category = walking in the store to look for a specific style
2. Browse styles and look book = browsing through clothing racks and looking at mannequins
3. AI Fitting Room = trying out clothes in a retail store's fitting room
4. Payment page = cashier

Problem/opportunity addressed

As I explored Heritage Bay's website, I found that the website is more of a product showcase rather than an experience. As a user, I did find it hard to picture how the products will look on me, and it was quite intimidating to look at the size guide, especially for the jeans section. Heritage Bay also lacks a permanent retail space, and currently only relies on occasional pop-ups. The AI fitting room solves that by generating an image of the user wearing the product.

Additionally, I would not have known what HERIBA Studios mean, until I click into it. Batik is known to be a traditional art technique and people often associate it to something that only older adults would wear. Heritage Bay's intention is to show that batik pieces can be worn by anyone through design, so having an experience dedicated to exploring styling options for batik wear would make the brand more appealing to its target audience.

Alignment with Heritage Bay's Brand

Heritage Bay is a brand that aims to make traditional southeast-asian craft relevant by "blending cultural authenticity through contemporary design" (Heritage Bay). During their sharing, its co-founder mentioned that the brand is currently lacking emotional appeal from its target audience (young people and young families). This experience would bridge that gap by providing customers with an interactive AI experience, helping them visualise how the product will look like on themselves. When they see themselves in the clothing piece and the possibility of wearing it, they'll realise that actually, Batik does suit them. This increases the likeliness of them purchasing the product and supporting Heritage Bay.

Insights and Strategic Perspective

I recently participated in a historical interactive experience booth by The Founder's Memorial, and their use of AI caught my eye. They used a chatbot to stimulate a conversation between the participants and fictional characters from the past. As a participant, I was very intrigued and highly engaged with the chatbot segment of the experience. It made me realise that AI itself can be an experience.

As I approached the assignment, I realised that my prototype was missing the interactive experience itself. I recalled how AI made my experience in the interactive booth so memorable, and decided to incorporate AI into this project. Image generation has been a hot topic surrounding the use of AI, thus it was apparent to me to make use of the idea of image generation to create a brand experience.